

ties even have face-to-face tutorials, laboratory sessions, summer schools, etc. Internet communication is also enabling new levels of communication between professors and distance students.

E-learning, on the other hand, is not primarily designed with guidance in mind, unless it's as a supplement to an on-campus course. However, this may vary with each university, which could charge for specific supplementary classes on campus and not for the entire course. This is one area where characteristics could overlap but just barely. Guidance is one of the main features of distance learning but not of e-learning.

Target audience

Distance education courses are mostly targeted at individuals who need to enhance their education profiles with a full-time course but either don't have the time for it or distance is a limitation. These individuals can be students or working professionals. Other target audiences include individuals who can't attend the full course due to health issues, don't fulfill the formal entry qualifications, or those who are based in closed institutions such as hospitals and prisons.

Due to its subject-based structure (you can access specific subjects for learning), the target audience for e-learning is much more diverse in nature – ranging from remotely located students to students within the college and working professionals. For on-campus students, the online mode of delivery comes in handy for activities such as lab work, classes, seminars, assignments and projects. For professionals, it's useful for enhancing their knowledge in a particular field.

Mode of delivery

Distance learning is dispensed through a mix of print, multimedia and interactive computer technology. This material is delivered to you at regular intervals via regular mail or, nowadays, through the internet.

E-learning, as the name implies, is electronically delivered. It makes use of the internet to deliver courses in various forms such as text, audio and video. The quizzes, tests and topics could be interactive in nature.

Frequency of delivery

Since distance learning courses are based on actual university courses, the study material may be delivered either simultaneously as university classes progress or semester-wise.